SCANDESK DESKTOP · THE PAPERPORT UPGRADE

Scan it. Find it. Done.

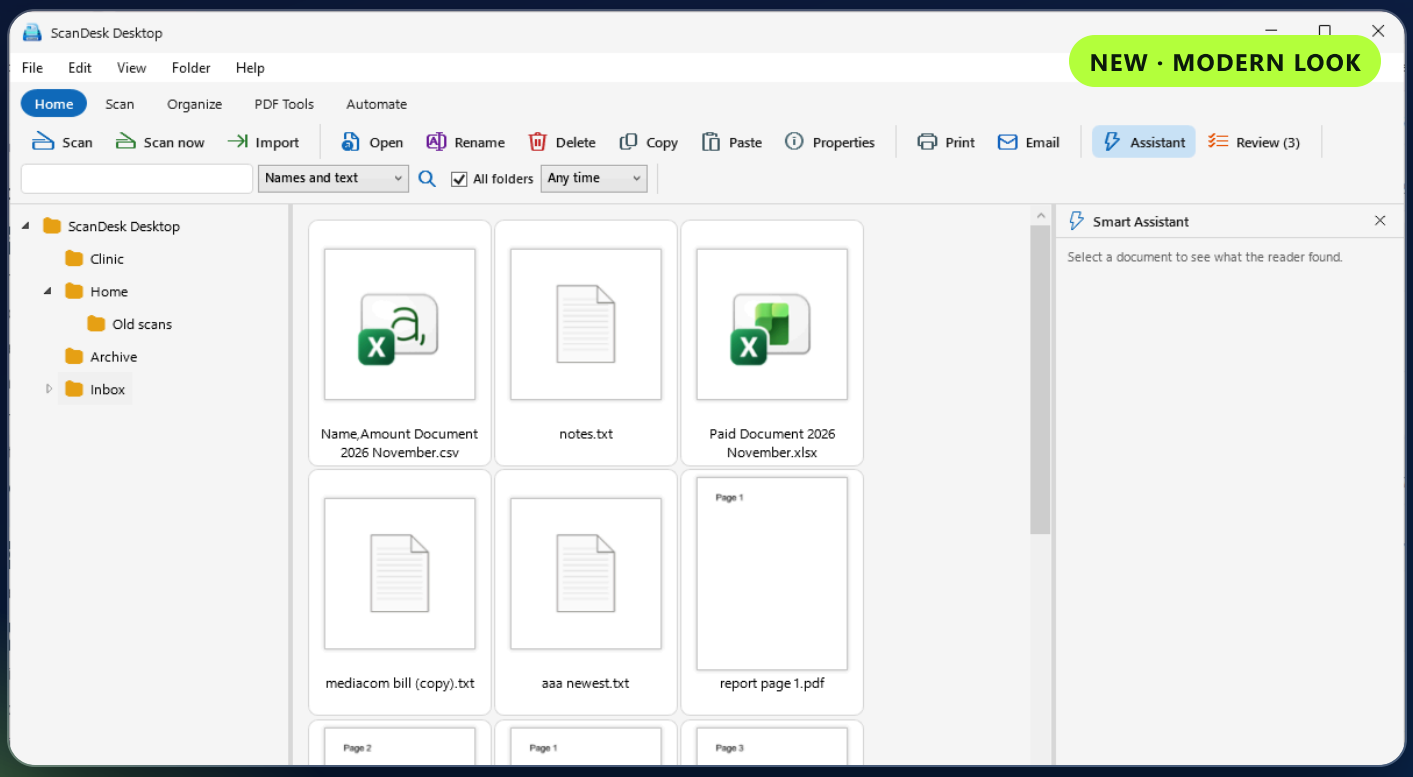
Your scanner still works. Your filing software is from **2011**. ScanDesk is the 2026 version of the same desk: **faster at every step**, searchable in plain English, and your documents stay plain PDFs in folders you own.

5.6×
faster to a usable window at start (1.2 s vs 6.7 s)

20×
faster from double-click to the document open (0.14 s vs 2.8 s)

0.18 s
to open a folder of 153 scans, thumbnails and all (PaperPort: 1.4 s)

0 MB
of proprietary files. No lock-in, no "convert before you leave".



Measured 2026-11-02 on one PC, same folder, same files, both programs. Full numbers on page 2.

Why you'll actually like it

Built by an office that lived in PaperPort for fifteen years and wanted the good parts back, minus the waiting, the splash screens and the .max files.

Ask in plain words

"The eye clinic lease from two years ago." "What do I owe the cable company." ScanDesk finds it by meaning, not just by keyword. The model runs on your PC; nothing leaves the building.

Your files stay your files

Plain PDFs in normal folders. OneDrive, a network share, Explorer, backups, any other program: they all see the same documents. Delete ScanDesk tomorrow and you lose nothing.

A smart assistant that asks first

Suggested names, dates and folders, filing rules with a preview and an undo, a duplicate finder with side-by-side compare. Nothing moves until you say so.

Everything PaperPort did

Scan profiles, blank-page splits, print-to-desktop, stacks, unstack a single page, clean-up, annotations, fillable forms, passwords, Send To bar, split desktop, watched folders, the scanner button.

Classic or Modern, your call

The PaperPort-style ribbon you know, or a Windows 11 look with cards and a command bar. One click in View > Appearance, no restart. Light, gray or dark.

Quiet by design

No cloud, no telemetry, no account. Updates are verified before they install. An audit log records who did what, with export. A crash never loses a page: previous versions are kept.

The receipts

SAME PC, SAME 153 SCANNED PDFS	PAPERPORT 14.7	SCANDESK 0.8
Start until the window is on screen	6.7 s	1.2 s
Open the folder, every thumbnail drawn	1.40 s	0.18 s
Double-click a document until the viewer exists	2.8 s	0.14 s
Double-click until the page is drawn	3.1 s	1.24 s
Architecture	32-bit, version 14 since 2011, proprietary .max	64-bit, built 2026, plain PDF
Search by meaning · filing rules · duplicate finder · audit log	No	Yes

Moving over takes an afternoon

- Point ScanDesk at the folders you already have. Nothing is moved or copied.
- Old .max files? ScanDesk converts them to PDF in a batch, originals kept.
- Your scanner, your scan button and your print-to-desktop keep working.

Honest small print

- No PDF/A, no cloud or SharePoint connectors (on purpose: local only).
- English OCR ships in the box; other languages are a file drop.
- Uses more memory than PaperPort (one 64-bit process does all the work).

Try the Modern look today.

Signed installer, one click to update, Classic look one click away.

github.com/msb2020-ux/scandesk-releases

Timings: medians of three scripted rounds on 2026-11-02, Intel Core i7-10700, Windows 11, NVMe SSD, same folder of 153 one-page scanned PDFs, warm caches; a step counts as done when the window stops changing. PaperPort Professional is a product of Tungsten Automation. ScanDesk Desktop 0.8.0.